MOST IMPROVED BIG STATES GOVERNANCE

RANK 2022	STATE	SCORE OUT OF 120	RANK 2021
1	PUNJAB	98.2	2
2	TAMIL NADU	92.4	5
3	HARYANA	92.0	6
4	WEST BENGAL	85.5	1
4	BIHAR	85.5	7
6	MAHARASHTRA	79.5	3
7	ASSAM	73.8	4
8	ODISHA	73.7	12
9	UTTARAKHAND	68.9	11
10	UTTAR PRADESH	67.5	17
11	JHARKHAND	65.3	14
12	GUJARAT	63.4	8
13	TELANGANA	56.5	15
14	KARNATAKA	53.8	9
15	HIMACHAL PRADESH	47.6	16
15	MADHYA PRADESH	47.6	19
17	RAJASTHAN	41.6	13
18	KERALA	40.0	10
19	CHHATTISGARH	39.9	20
20	ANDHRA PRADESH	35.7	18

MOST IMPROVED SMALL STATES GOVERNANCE

RANK 2022	STATE	SCORE OUT OF 120	RANK 2021
1	ARUNACHAL PRADESH	72.3	1
2	TRIPURA	72.2	2
3	MANIPUR	61.8	5
4	SIKKIM	61.3	4
5	NAGALAND	56.3	3
6	PUDUCHERRY	55.3	10
7	MIZORAM	51.1	6
8	DELHI	49.5	7
9	GOA	41.1	8
10	MEGHALAYA	35.9	9

of operational common service centres, number of panchayats providing e-services, ease of doing business index, progress on Digital India programme

ONLY 17 PER CENT MLAS IN ARUNACHAL PRADESH HAVE CRIMINAL RECORDS—AMONG THE LOWEST IN INDIA

to facilitate ease of living for citizens. Technology helps us achieve that goal more effectively," says the CM. In education, Manipur has launched the System Transformation and Rejuvenation of Education (STAR)—an innovative data-driven platform that integrates high-quality learning material and effective teachers' training.

Most Improved Big State: Punjab

In March, Punjab saw a historic mandate for the AAP's Bhagwant Mann amid apprehension about the party's capacity to provide governance. Its biggest task is to strengthen panchayats. When the pandemic froze governance operations, digitisation of panchayat services was stuck at 92.3 per cent. Data shows that the state is still at 0.19 on indices defining panchayat at devolution. This is the index measuring the functions, finance and functionaries of panchayati raj institutions. Punjab now provides only 42 digital services for citizen's participation, whereas Haryana provides 549. Rajasthan 500 and Himachal Pradesh 96. But the state is responding to digitisation positively. Data shows that every Punjabi did 11.326 digital transactions in 2021-22. The state has around 41 per cent women's participation, whereas many states have crossed the 50 per cent mark. Mann came with a promise of change. If he can use his political will to improve these data points, he can ensure that change happens for good.

Most Improved Small State: Arunachal Pradesh

For Arunachal Pradesh CM Pema Khandu, the real test of development lies in reaching out to those on the margins. "Arunachal Pradesh is an example of wholesome development. It is the vision of *Sabka Saath, Sabka Vikas*...that the state is witnessing development on all fronts," says Khandu. Buoyed by the Centre's Digital India programme, Arunachal Pradesh announced 22 IT projects; of these 12 are in force. The government has also rolled out 18 e-services through the police department and district administration. To help them, 210 common service centres (CSC) are operational. Following the passage of the Ease of Doing Business (EoDB) Act in the assembly, the Khandu government has launched the Single Window Clearance Portal (EoDB Portal) and integrated it with the National Single Window System. The Central Inspection System (CIS) portal is also live. Women's representation in Panchayati Raj institutions has been impressive at nearly 50 per cent—of 8,164 representatives in Panchayati Raj institutions, 3,865 are women. Also, only 17 per cent of MLAs have criminal records. ■

–Kaushik Deka and Anilesh S. Mahajan